



Leadership Covenant.

“As iron sharpens iron, so one person sharpens another.” Proverbs 27:17

This page summarizes the covenant. The full sections that follow explain each commitment and govern in case of any difference. Initial each line only after you have read the full section and had your questions answered.

INITIAL	1 DOCTRINE. I have read the Statement of Faith, I agree with it, and I will not teach, publish, or promote content against it.
INITIAL	2 DAILY FAITH. I will pray daily as the first priority, read Scripture daily, attend church at least three times per month, and serve at least twice per month.
INITIAL	3 CONDUCT. I will pursue a life above reproach in my speech, integrity, sexual conduct, handling of money, and use of authority. I will not meet alone or hold private deep personal conversations one on one with the opposite sex. Meetings are public or with a second leader.
INITIAL	4 CONTENT. Scripture I use in published content will be verified, and content goes through the ministry review process before publishing under the ministry name.
INITIAL	5 ROLE. I will carry out my role, attend the named gatherings at least twice per week, prepare adequately, and tell my co-leader early when I cannot fulfill a responsibility.
INITIAL	6 AUTHORITY. I report to the Table (Head of Groups) with my co-leader, and I will submit to its decisions, except where a decision would require me to act against Scripture.
INITIAL	7 CORRECTION. I agree to the correction process, which follows Matthew 18 and aims at restoration, and I will not step down solely to avoid a process already underway.
INITIAL	8 CONFIDENTIALITY. I will protect sensitive information learned through this role.
INITIAL	9 CONTENT OWNERSHIP. Content I create for the ministry in this role belongs to the ministry as stated in Section 9, and I will return access and materials when I leave.
INITIAL	10 ONLINE. When representing the ministry publicly I will act consistently with this covenant and its review process.
INITIAL	11 TERM. This covenant runs for the stated term, is reviewed with the Table, and I may resign with written notice, subject to Section 7.
INITIAL	12 REMOVAL. The Table may remove me from leadership for serious or unrepentant violation of this covenant.
INITIAL	13 RESPONSIBILITY. I accept personal responsibility for my own conduct in this role.
INITIAL	14 YOUTH PROTECTION. I will never be alone one on one with a minor out of sight of others, I will keep communication with minors in group or parent-included channels, and I will report suspected abuse to authorities immediately.
INITIAL	15 THIS DOCUMENT. This is a covenant and volunteer agreement, not an employment contract.

Full text begins on the next page. The signature page is at the end.

PREAMBLE

A covenant of leadership

This is a covenant between *[ORGANIZATION NAME: Christfields, a ministry of Iron and Ember]* and *[LEADER NAME]*, entered into on *[DATE]*.

Leadership in this ministry is a responsibility, not a right. It is extended to those who submit to the authority of Scripture and who agree to lead in a manner consistent with it (*Scripture: 1 Timothy 3:1-7; Titus 1:5-9; 1 Peter 5:1-4*).

This document serves two purposes. It protects those served by the ministry by setting clear standards for those who lead. It protects the leader by stating plainly what is expected and how concerns are handled. It is grounded in the conviction that those who teach and lead are held to a higher standard (*Scripture: James 3:1*).

By signing, the leader agrees to the commitments below and agrees to be held accountable to them.

SECTION 1

Doctrinal affirmation

The leader affirms that:

- I have read the *[ORGANIZATION NAME]* Statement of Faith *[attached as Appendix A or located at: _____]* and I personally agree with it.
- I will not teach, publish, or promote content under this ministry that contradicts the Statement of Faith.
- If my beliefs change such that I can no longer affirm the Statement of Faith, I will inform the Table (Head of Groups) promptly rather than teach contrary to it while holding a leadership role.

SECTION 2

Personal faith and spiritual life

The leader affirms and commits to:

- A personal relationship with Jesus Christ evidenced by ongoing worship, prayer, and study of Scripture (*Scripture: Hebrews 10:24-25*).
- Maintaining personal spiritual practices consistent with the faith I am asking others to follow.
- Continued growth rather than a fixed or complacent faith (*Scripture: 2 Peter 3:18*).

I commit to practicing my faith daily, not only when serving in this role. At minimum:

- PRAYER, AS THE FIRST PRIORITY. I will pray daily (*Scripture: 1 Thessalonians 5:17; Luke 18:1*).
- SCRIPTURE. I will read Scripture daily (*Scripture: Psalm 1:2; Joshua 1:8*).
- CHURCH. I will attend church at least three times per month (*Scripture: Hebrews 10:24-25*).
- SERVING. I will serve at least twice per month (*Scripture: 1 Peter 4:10; Galatians 5:13*).

SECTION 3

Character and conduct standards

The leader agrees to pursue a life above reproach (*Scripture: 1 Timothy 3:2*) and to reflect the character described in Scripture (*Scripture: Galatians 5:22-23*). Specifically, I will:

- SPEAK in a way that builds others up, and I will avoid gossip, slander, and dishonesty (*Scripture: Ephesians 4:29*).
- MAINTAIN INTEGRITY in my words and actions, including keeping commitments and telling the truth (*Scripture: Titus 2:7*).

- UPHOLD SEXUAL CONDUCT consistent with the ministry's stated beliefs (*Scripture: 1 Thessalonians 4:3-8*). [*State the position explicitly here.*]
- HANDLE FINANCES AND RESOURCES honestly and transparently, and I will not use my position for personal financial gain (*Scripture: 1 Peter 5:2*).
- NOT MISUSE THE AUTHORITY of my position over anyone in my care (*Scripture: Matthew 20:25-28*).

One-on-one boundaries

- I will not meet alone with a member of the opposite sex. Meetings happen in public, observable settings or with a second leader present.
- I will not carry on private, emotionally deep, or ongoing personal one-on-one conversations with a member of the opposite sex, in person or by message. Emotional attachment forms through private vulnerable conversation, so a care conversation of this kind is referred to a leader of the same sex or held with a second leader present (*Scripture: 1 Timothy 5:1-2; 2 Timothy 2:22; Romans 13:14; Proverbs 27:12*).
- These rules apply regardless of intent, maturity, or how trusted either person is. They protect the member, the leader, and the ministry, and they remove the situation where a leader must defend their intentions.

I understand that conduct such as habitual drunkenness, drug abuse, sexual immorality, violation of the one-on-one boundary rules above, use of the position for personal gain, financial dishonesty, and abuse of others are treated as serious violations of this covenant.

SECTION 4

Content and doctrinal fidelity

Because this ministry produces and publishes teaching content, the leader agrees that:

- Any Scripture I cite in published content will be verified against the text and confirmed accurate before publishing.
- I will submit Scripture-based content through the ministry's review and audit process before it is published under the [*ORGANIZATION NAME*] name.
- I will represent the ministry's teaching accurately and will not present personal opinion as the ministry's position.

SECTION 5

Role and responsibilities

Role title: [*ROLE TITLE*]. The leader agrees to:

- Carry out the responsibilities of this role as described in [*attached role description or list them here*].
- Attend [*name the ministry gathering, e.g. leadership meeting and group meeting*] at least twice per week.
- Prepare adequately for my responsibilities.
- Communicate to my co-leader as early as possible when I cannot fulfill a responsibility or need to be absent (*Scripture: Colossians 3:23*).
- Follow the guidelines and standards set by the ministry for this role.

SECTION 6

Structure, authority, and accountability

Structure

- Each group is led by two leaders who lead it together. One of the two is a representative of Iron and Ember. Leaders serve in pairs, not alone (*Scripture: Mark 6:7; Luke 10:1*).
- The two leaders of a group report to the Head of Groups.
- The Head of Groups is a body referred to here as the Table. The Table is made up of devoted members who pray, fast, read Scripture, and deliberate together to reach agreement on decisions (*Scripture: Acts 13:2-3; Acts 14:23*).
- When the Table reaches agreement on a question, its decision is sent to all leaders, and leaders carry it out. This follows the pattern of the council at Jerusalem, which deliberated a disputed question, reached agreement, and sent the decision to the wider body (*Scripture: Acts 15:6-29; Acts 15:28*).

The leader affirms

- I understand that I report to the Table as the Head of Groups.
- I will raise disagreements directly and respectfully, first to my co-leader and then to the Table, rather than through division (*Scripture: Hebrews 13:17*).
- I will receive correction, instruction, and feedback as part of serving in this role.
- I will submit to decisions the Table reaches through prayer, fasting, Scripture, and agreement, except where a decision would require me to act against Scripture (*Scripture: Acts 5:29*).

The Table is also bound

- The Table is under the same Scripture and Statement of Faith as every leader. Its authority rests on faithfulness to Scripture, not on position. Any teaching or decision is to be measured against Scripture (*Scripture: Isaiah 8:20; Acts 17:11*).

SECTION 7

Correction, discipline, and restoration

The purpose of correction in this ministry is restoration, not punishment (*Scripture: Galatians 6:1*). The leader agrees to the following process:

1. DIRECT CONVERSATION. If a concern arises about my conduct, teaching, or fulfillment of this covenant, it will first be raised with me directly (*Scripture: Matthew 18:15*).
2. WIDER INVOLVEMENT. If the concern is not resolved, one or more additional people from the ministry may be included (*Scripture: Matthew 18:16*).
3. FORMAL REVIEW. If the matter remains unresolved and is serious enough not to overlook, it will be addressed by the Table as the Head of Groups, which may result in a period of stepping back, a plan for restoration, or removal from leadership (*Scripture: Matthew 18:17*).

I further agree that:

- I will not withdraw from this covenant solely to avoid a correction process that is already underway. I remain free to step down at any time, but stepping down while a concern is being addressed does not end the process (*Scripture: Hebrews 12:11*).
- Where the goal of restoration is met and repentance is confirmed, restoration to fellowship and, where appropriate, to service, will be pursued gladly (*Scripture: 2 Corinthians 2:5-8*).
- Details of any correction process will be kept as confidential as the situation allows, shared only with those who need to be involved.

Standards apply regardless of a person's role, gifts, or contribution to the ministry.

SECTION 8

Confidentiality

The leader agrees to protect confidential and sensitive information learned through this role, including personal information shared by those the ministry serves, and to share it only where there is a clear and appropriate reason to do so.

SECTION 9

Intellectual property and content ownership

Have an attorney review this section.

The leader agrees that:

- Content I create for or on behalf of *[ORGANIZATION NAME]*, including written material, designs, and social media content produced in this role, is *[owned by the ministry / licensed to the ministry. Choose one and state it clearly]*.
- I will not publish ministry content on personal channels as my own without permission.
- On leaving the role, I will *[return / stop using / transfer access to]* ministry accounts, materials, and content as directed.

[State clearly what the leader may keep and what reverts to the ministry.]

SECTION 10

Online representation

When representing *[ORGANIZATION NAME]* publicly, including on its social media platforms, the leader agrees to:

- Post in a manner consistent with the Statement of Faith and the conduct standards in this covenant.
- Follow the ministry's content format and review process.
- Not use ministry platforms for personal disputes, unrelated promotion, or content that would bring reproach on the ministry.

SECTION 11

Term, review, and resignation

- This covenant is effective from *[START DATE]* for a period of *[TERM LENGTH, e.g. 12 months]*, after which it may be reviewed and renewed.
- The Table and the leader will review this covenant *[annually / at term end]*.
- The leader may resign from the role at any time by giving *[NOTICE PERIOD]* notice in writing to the Table (Head of Groups), subject to Section 7.

SECTION 12

Removal from leadership

Leadership may be revoked by the Table (Head of Groups) for reasons including:

- A serious or unrepentant violation of this covenant.
- Persistent failure to fulfill the responsibilities of the role.
- Teaching or publishing content that contradicts the Statement of Faith after being asked to stop.
- Conduct that harms those the ministry serves or brings serious reproach on the ministry.

Removal follows the process in Section 7 where circumstances reasonably allow. In cases of conduct that risks immediate harm to others, the ministry may act promptly to protect those involved.

SECTION 13

Liability and personal responsibility

Have an attorney review this section.

The leader accepts personal responsibility for their own conduct in this role and agrees not to hold *[ORGANIZATION NAME]*, its founders, or its representatives liable for actions the leader takes outside the ministry's direction. *[Attorney: confirm language and enforceability under Colorado law. Some leaders are under 18, so agreement to this section requires the parent or guardian co-signature on the signature page; Colorado's age of contractual competence is CRS 13-22-101. If the ministry later adds participant activity waivers, parental release of prospective negligence claims is governed by CRS 13-22-107.]*

SECTION 14

Youth protection

Because this ministry involves minors, both as members and as leaders, the leader agrees to the following. These rules protect the people in our care and protect leaders from false accusation. They are not optional and are not softened by trust or familiarity.

- NO ONE ALONE WITH A MINOR. I will not be alone one on one with a minor out of the sight of others, in any room, vehicle, or private setting. Meetings happen in open, observable places with at least two screened, unrelated leaders present.
- MINOR LEADERS SERVE UNDER ADULT OVERSIGHT. A leader under 18 serves under the supervision of a screened adult and is never left solely responsible for a group of minors.
- COMMUNICATION. Electronic communication with minors happens in group channels or with a parent or second leader included. No private one on one messaging with a minor.
- REPORTING. If I learn of or reasonably suspect abuse or neglect of a minor, I will report it immediately to the Colorado Child Abuse and Neglect Hotline at 1-844-264-5437, or to 911 if there is immediate danger. I will also inform the Table. Telling the Table does not replace the report to authorities, and no leader may instruct another leader not to report.
- SCREENING. I have completed the ministry's screening process for my role and consent to renewal of that screening.

SECTION 15

Acknowledgment

The leader acknowledges:

- This is a covenant and volunteer agreement. It is not an employment contract and does not create an employment relationship or a promise of compensation, unless a separate written agreement states otherwise.
- This covenant was walked through with me in person, and my questions were answered before I signed.
- I received this covenant at least seven days before signing and prayed over this commitment before signing (*Scripture: Proverbs 20:25; Ecclesiastes 5:2, 4-5; Luke 14:28*).
- I initialed each line of the Covenant Summary after reading the corresponding section.
- I have read this document, I understand it, and I agree to it freely.

SIGNATURES

Sign it before God and before people.

Process record

WALKED THROUGH IN
PERSON BY

DATE OF WALKTHROUGH

DATE COVENANT GIVEN
TO LEADER

DATE SIGNED (AT LEAST
SEVEN DAYS AFTER
RECEIVING)

Leader

PRINTED NAME

SIGNATURE

DATE

On behalf of [organization name]

PRINTED NAME

ROLE

SIGNATURE

DATE

Parent or legal guardian (required if the leader is under 18)

I am the parent or legal guardian of the leader named above. I have read this covenant, I consent to my child serving in this leadership role, and I agree to its terms on their behalf.

PRINTED NAME

RELATIONSHIP TO
LEADER

SIGNATURE

DATE

Appendix A: Statement of Faith [attach] · Appendix B: Role description [attach if used]